Life of a Loud Mime

March 2026

WHAT IS THIS?

In what it seems like a flagellant joke, I decided to start a self-made newspaper-styled montly report of my life. Because my perilous writing skills are only second to my ability to artistically design stuff; so this might be the best chance I have to remind myself of how much I suck at things. And because self-deprecating attitudes are quite common nowadays, I will also allow some of my close friends to remind me of my gruesome skills by sharing these pages with them.

CLOSED IN A BOX

I've never reflected much about claustrophobia, until I heard Micheal Stevens use the word in one of his podcasts, describing the feelings when imagining the prospects of an infinite life. It's interesting that I have never dedicated too much attention to that word, as I now realize how recurrent, important, and broad its meaning has been for many encounters I had in my life. Starting with Micheal's interpetation, I found it surprisingly beatiful to associate immortality with the feeling of being stuck in a closed space. So clear and obvious when you spell it out, but yet counterintuitive if heard for the first time. And indeed, this meaning is conceptually opposite to another reflection I heard in my life. Back in my early university years in Modena, I remember helping a old lady carrying her heavy bags back home. She was a stranger, but the exchanges we had were rich in meaning. She was old, crippled, and claustrophobic in the literal sense of the term. She was also midly religious, and reflecting on the prospect of dying, she stated that death was not a scary thing to her; except for one thing. What she was scared of was not death itself, but the idea that death could feel like being stuck in a dark and small box, essentially triggering her claustrophobia. It's an encounter I never forgot, but this specific reflection came out bright for its opposite dynamics compared to the claustrophobic immortality; yet both visions hold such truthful meaning within them. As the word's meaning kept silently bouncing in my head, I then realized another important interpetation of it. While indirectly touched, claustrophobia was the core of how my mom explained her feeling when she ended up having an affair with my dad many years ago. In her words, she explained how she felt trapped in a dark room with no visible exits. The lover eventually showed her a door out, revealing a way to freedom and self-realization. And then, finally, I too found meaning in the word to describe how my internal space seems like whenever I am in a condition where I'm bounded to not have free choice. And regarding this, I've always been a spoiled brat. I have never easily accepted unwilling choices, and always chased what I wanted to do over what it was best to do. A behaviour I've always critized of my mom, but that I can now see and understand very clearly within myself. In our conflicted relation, I always thought she would struggle to deal with me because of my similiarities with my father; except that with me she could not escape -- the blood bound we shared was simply too strong. Today I realized that I also suffer from a similar problem. That I struggle to deal with myself because of my similiarities with her, except that I can't really escape myself.

Ethipian Coffee.
That stuff is so damn good I sometimes forget I am supposed to prefer Italian coffee.

Don't mind this.
Just me explaining to Sai the actual culture of Wales.

FAIL LIKE A PHD

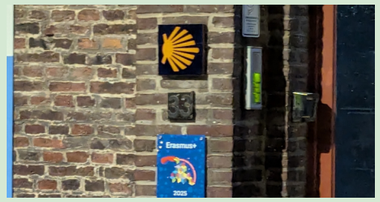
March for me really started only in the middle. After the first 2 weeks of essentially flat time passing, I've got hit by a paper rejection. A good and old 'failure' that always shepherded me during my whole PhD journey. In fact, it was actually a while since I have been facing a failure as such. While this rejection doesn't really affect my PhD nor put me in any particular state of stress, it still threw me in a very focused and "try-hard" kind of mood. A very much needed thing, as I felt my vision and effort at work were getting losts and confused. Since then, I gained an incredible amount of motivation and inspiration; at the cost, alas, of my personal life time. It's a weird thing, investing in myself. It always feel like to get very good at something and allow myself to thrive and grow in a project, I need to leave anything else aside as irrelevant and waste of my time. The whole idea of waste of my time gets, in my head, a toxic interpretation; as anything that does not allow me to clearly grow and improve and get better at something is a waste of time. It's like having a constant feel of shame whenever I am not dedicating my efforts towards personal achievements. And I cannot help but wonder how long will this mentality last? Is this even healthy for me? When the meaning of life will shift towards something different than my personal growth, will I be ready to accept the sad reality of it? Regardless of those questions, I do feel like this paper rejection really helped me get a grip. Spending too much time in a easy and stable position makes me too relaxed, and I tend to stop working on myself. I surely need to find a better balance, but while I work on this, I prefer being on the work-hard side rather than on the other one.

PANIC IS A CURRENCY

March has been a tough month for my mental stability. The world has... Not changed much, War has always been out there, except that lately it has been violently displayed in our faces. And specifically, us privileged people got exposed with something that probably feels not bearable: the prospect that this time war might impact us directly. Because really, the reason why the news I've heard in the last couple of weeks did generate a oppressive anxiety clamp in my stomach is just the realization that, in the big picture, my life is worth nothing. That it can disappear with the same ease as the ones that are being taken now and the ones that have been taken since possibly the beginning of life. And thinking about it makes me realize that what is happening now is really nothing new. Heavily enlightening was the movie 'A Complete Unknown', showing that the prospect of out society being blown off has always been there before us, inspiring the songs of Bob Dylan and of God's know how many other artists before in the the whole history of humanity. It is not a coincidence, I reckon, that in this specific time of my life I am getting closer and closer to the music genres of folk. Acoustic and simple, it feels like a storytelling genre; and that is exactly what I value now to keep me grounded on reality. Early this year, in a poem I wrote, I came out with the expression "Panic is a currency, nowadays". It really feels like modern society treat anxiety as some sort of economy, where the consumers are being driven by those with power towards their interest, while panic is being exchanged. And, as I continued in that poem: "Money can only get you to more money than before". The metaphore sticks a lot in my head. As for the money and many other society behavioral convenctions, it is on us to decide whether we decide to aggregate and willingly accepts the trade, or step out and reject the given rule.

Random boulder.
I am not sure how I ended up in that position, but I look cool in it.

My plant bloomed some flowers.
How cute is that.



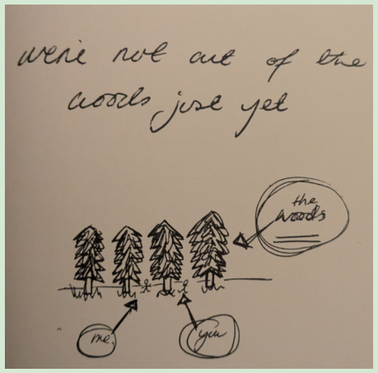
Santiago Shell.
Found this in a random street of Ghent. Those experiences feel so far, but their symbols are still bright in my heart.

Wisps of smoke caressed the mountains beneath the moon
The sky fell backwards, a deep and dark green blue
The gaze you cast was absent when you were there, it wasn't you
A shell of who you were before the hurt inside there grew
Chew down on your emotions, volcanic ruptures brew
Colder as the days go by like early morning dew
A different kind of blue, miles gone too soon
Afflicted feelings bloom, past trauma is a tomb
I can see why you might choose
To blame someone else before you lose
Track of who you were as the night begins to loom
The air inside the room became thicker than a fool
You could cut it with a knife, so it's safe to not assume
The shadows of your past, they dance behind your sunken eyes
Subconsciously contract, over time you say you're fine
Over time you learn to cry, but anxiety made you shy
Clutching to the lies, you tell yourself, not satisfied

The Invisible Man -- Maruja

How can you ever be prepared to die?
"Do what the Buddhists do. Every day, have a little bird in your shoulder that asks, 'Is today the day? Am I ready? Am I doing all I need to do? Am I being the person I want to be?' "
He turned his head to his shoulder as if the bird was there now.
"Is today the day I die?" he said.

from
'tuesdays with Morrie' -- Mitch Albom



from
Useless Magic -- Florence Welch.
Not out of the woods yet...

MY MUSICAL MONTH WRAPPED

- Strangers -- Black Country, New Road
- Paper Bag -- Fiona Apple
- Slow Talkin' -- Haley Heynderickx
- Heat Ray -- Calimossa
- The Invisible Man -- Maruja
- Song for Alicia -- Haley Heynderickx, Max Garcia Conover
- Gemini -- Haley Heynderickx

DISCLAIMER :)

This text has been entirely written by humans. Any generative AI has been intenionally avoided. The natural consequence of this choice is the raising of imperfections all over the document. Imperfections are among the most human things I know; and they surely are a pure indication of my deepest and core being. In a world where technology is taking over all of our human functions, it is our own responsibility to step back and enjoy the slow, dull process of creating things by ourselves.